

The First Real Deadline: A Signal

第一个真实期限：一个信号

Theme: 求职、职场与职业发展 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6, 127

English Story

At home they had learned to write down who did what; the office preferred a deadline to a promise. The fourth arc began **downtown**, in a **spacious** office with a **gigantic carpet** and a view of the **orbital** tower. A **prominent businessman** said “hi” to **them** without looking up, and the **management** team arrived ten minutes later. “We want a film about our new **technological** platform,” the woman said. “You will **supervise** the script, and you will receive a small fee.” Various people around the table produced a phone and took notes, like a boy at his first interview.

The **agenda** was **mostly financial**. A secretary took the minutes; a **broker** consulted his phone; a **reactionary** older man wanted to **commercialize** everything before the test. “**Progress** is not a **pace**,” Lin said. “It is a direction.” “Then **straighten** your **stride**,” the **businessman** replied, “and **delete** the last paragraph.” From that morning the work would be supervised by the client, not by the university.

Their **departure** from the campus was **compulsory** for the summer: an internship, they were told, would teach **them** more than a lecture. A young daughter of the union organizer worked there too, and a boy from the mailroom applied for the same post. “You will **discover**,” said the woman, “that most of what we make is **invisible**. That is what makes it hard to manage.”

The work itself was to **administrate** a small civic tool: a tool that would **industrialize** nothing, **defy** the market, and never be **profitable**. “It will fail,” the **broker** said. “It does not need to be **profitable**,” Maya replied. “It needs to be accurate.” Without that, the whole platform was a film about a building.

Wealth descended and rose around them, and the young persisted. “We do not receive praise here,” she said. “We receive deadlines.” A **farewell** lunch was held for the last intern, and an email went **upwards** and **downwards** through the company before he had finished his coffee. A **big** question imposed itself: could a pupil from a public school **succeed** here, where a **secretarial** salary was a **dime** above the **housework** rate? Nobody could say what would happen next, and nobody wanted to lead with that. His face, like hers, said that the work would continue without them, and that this was the price of a real deadline.

中文翻译

在家里，他们学会了把谁做什么写下来；而办公室更喜欢一个截止日期，而不是一个承诺。第四段弧线从市中心开始，在一间宽敞的办公室，铺着巨大的地毯，窗户正对轨道塔。一位有名的商人头也不抬地对他们说了声“嗨”，管理团队十分钟后才到。“我们想拍一部关于我们新科技平台的影片，”那位女士说，“你们来监督脚本，会收到一笔小小的报酬。”桌边各种各样的人掏出手机做记录，像第一次参加面试的男孩。

议程主要是财务性的。一位秘书做记录；一位经纪人查手机；一位年长而反动的先生想在测试之前就把一切商业化。“进步不是步速，”林伟说，“而是一个方向。”“那就把你的步子走直，”商人回答，“把最后一段删掉。”从那天早上起，工作由客户而不是大学来监督。

他们夏天离开校园是强制性的：有人告诉他们，一段实习能教给他们比一堂课更多的东西。工会组织者年轻的女儿也在那里工作，收发室的一个男孩申请了同一个岗位。“你们会发现，”那位女士说，“我们做的大部分事是看不见的。这正是它难以管理的原因。”

工作本身是管理一件小小的市政工具：一件不会让任何东西工业化、敢于违抗市场、也永远不会赚钱的工具。“它会失败，”经纪人说。“它不需要赚钱，”曼雅回答，“它需要准确。”没有这一点，整个平台就只是一部关于一栋建筑的影片。

财富在他们周围下降又上升，而年轻人坚持了下来。“我们在这里得不到表扬，”她说，“我们得到的是截止日期。”公司为最后一位实习生办了告别午餐，一封邮件在他喝完咖啡之前就上传下达了整个公司。一个大问题压了上来：一个公立学校出来的学生，能在这里成功吗？在这里，一份秘书的薪水只比家务工的时薪高一分钱。没有人说得清接下来会发生什么，也没有人愿意拿这件事开头。他的脸和她的脸都在说：工作会在没有他们的情况下继续下去，而这就是一个真实期限的代价。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
them ðem POS: pron	pron. 他们, 她们, 它们 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: pron. The objective case of they. See They.
big big POS: a	a. 大的, 重要的; adv. 大量地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. significant; s. loud and firm; s. conspicuous in position or importance; s. prodigious
management 'mænɪdʒmənt POS: n	n. 经营, 支配, 管理; [化] 管理处 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of managing something; n. those in charge of running a business
financial faɪ'nænʃəl POS: a	a. 财政的, 金融的; [经] 财政的, 金融的, 财务的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a involving financial matters
arrive ə'raɪv POS: vi	vi. 到达, 抵达 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. reach a destination; arrive by movement or progress; v. succeed in a big way; get to the top
discover dɪs'kʌvə POS: vt	vt. 发现, 找到, 暴露; vi. 发现 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. make a discovery, make a new finding; v. make a discovery; v. see for the first time; make a discovery
pupil 'pju:pl POS: n	n. 学生, 门生, 未成年人, 瞳孔; [医] 瞳孔 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the contractile aperture in the center of the iris of the eye; resembles a large black dot
progress 'prəʊɡres POS: n	n. 进步, 发展, 前进; vi. 进步, 进行 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of moving forward (as toward a goal); n. a movement forward; v. develop in a positive way
mostly 'məʊstli POS: adv	adv. 大概, 大部分, 主要; [经] 大部份 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r in large part; mainly or chiefly; r usually; as a rule
impose ɪm'pəʊz POS: vt	vt. 征(税), 把...强加于, 以...欺骗; vi. 利用, 欺骗, 施加影响 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v compel to behave in a certain way; v impose something unpleasant; v impose and collect
succeed sək'sɪd POS: vi	vi. 成功, 继承, 继续; vt. 继承, 接替 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. attain success or reach a desired goal; v. be the successor (of)
hi hai POS: review required	interj. 喂 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n an expression of greeting; n a state in the United States in the central Pacific on the Hawaiian Islands
agenda ə'dʒendə POS: review required	pl. 议程, 日常工作事项; [计] 待议事件 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a temporally organized plan for matters to be attended to; n. a list of matters to be taken up (as at a mee...
pace peɪs POS: n	n. 速度, 步调, 步法; vi. 踱步, 缓慢走; vt. 用步测, 踱步于 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the rate of moving (especially walking or running); n. the relative speed of progress or change; n. a step i...
carpet 'kɑ:pɪt POS: n	n. 地毯, 地毯状物; vt. 铺以地毯, 铺盖 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a natural object that resembles or suggests a carpet; v. form a carpet-like cover (over); v. cover completel...
consult kən'sʌlt POS: vi	vi. 商讨, 商量, 协商, 会诊; vt. 向...请教, 查阅, 考虑 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. get or ask advice from; v. seek information from; v. advise professionally
prominent 'prɒmɪnənt POS: a	a. 卓越的, 显著的, 突出的, 凸出的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s having a quality that thrusts itself into attention; s conspicuous in position or importance
departure dɪ'pɑ:tʃə POS: n	n. 离开, 出发, 违背, 偏离; [经] 启运 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of departing
downtown 'daʊn'taʊn POS: n	n. 市中心区; a. 市中心的; adv. 往闹市区 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. of or located in the lower part of a town, or in the business center; r. toward or in the lower or central...
businessman 'bɪznɪsmæn POS: n	n. 商人, 实业家, 工商业家 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person engaged in commercial or industrial business (especially an owner or executive)
technological 'tekne'lɒdʒɪkl POS: a	a. 技术的; [经] 工艺的, 技术的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. based in scientific and industrial progress
persist pə'sɪst POS: vi	vi. 坚持, 固执, 持续, 坚称; [经] 持续 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. stay behind
invisible ɪn'vɪzəbl POS: a	a. 看不见的, 无形的; [经] 无形的, 表面上看不见的, 未列在公开帐目的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. impossible or nearly impossible to see; imperceptible by the eye

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
descend di'send POS: vi	vi. 下降, 世代相传, 屈尊, 袭击; vt. 下降 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. move downward and lower, but not necessarily all the way
compulsory kəm'pʌlsəri POS: a	a. 被强制的, 强迫的, 义务的; [经] 强迫的, 强制的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. required by rule
broker 'brəʊkə POS: n	n. 掮客, 经纪人; [经] 经纪人, 掮客 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. act as a broker
upwards 'ʌpwədz POS: adv	adv. 以上, 向上 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r spatially or metaphorically from a lower to a higher position; r to a later time
profitable 'prɒfɪtəbl POS: a	a. 有利润的, 有利益的, 赚钱的; [经] 有利(可图)的, 合算的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. yielding material gain or profit
supervise 'sjʊ:pəvaɪz POS: v	v. 监督, 管理, 指导 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v watch and direct; v keep tabs on; keep an eye on; keep under surveillance
straighten streɪtn POS: vt	vt. 弄直, 整顿, 清理, 使改正; vi. 直起来, 改正, 好转 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. straighten up or out; make straight; v. make straight; v. get up from a sitting or slouching position; v. mak...
stride straɪd POS: n	n. 大步, 步幅, 步态, 进步; v. 迈大步走, 跨过, 跨 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. significant progress (especially in the phrase "make strides"); v. walk with long steps; v. cover or travers...
defy di'fai POS: vt	vt. 藐视, 挑衅, 使落空; n. 挑战 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. resist or confront with resistance; v. elude, especially in a baffling way; v. challenge
delete di'li:t POS: vt	vt. 删除; [计] 删除 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. remove or make invisible
downwards 'daʊnwədz POS: adv	adv. 向下 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r spatially or metaphorically from a higher to a lower level or position
farewell 'feəwel POS: n	n. 辞别, 再见, 再会; interj. 再会 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an acknowledgment or expression of goodwill at parting; n. the act of departing politely
spacious 'speɪʃəs POS: a	a. 广大的, 宽广的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s very large in expanse or scope; s (of buildings and rooms) having ample space
housework 'hauswɜ:k POS: n	n. 家事, 家务 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the work of cleaning and running a house
dime daɪm POS: n	n. 10分硬币(美、加) Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a United States coin worth one tenth of a dollar
gigantic dʒaɪ'gæntɪk POS: a	a. 巨人般的, 巨大的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. so exceedingly large or extensive as to suggest a giant or mammoth
orbital 'ɔ:bitəl POS: a	a. 轨道的, 眼眶的; [化] 轨道 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. of or relating to an orbit; a. of or relating to the eye socket
secretarial ,sekɹə'teəriəl POS: a	a. 秘书的, 书记的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. of or relating to a secretary or to a secretary's work
reactionary ri'ækʃənəri POS: n	n. 反动分子; a. 反动的, 反动主义的, 反对改革的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an extreme conservative; an opponent of progress or liberalism; s. extremely conservative
commercialize kə'mɜ:ʃəlaɪz POS: vt	vt. 使商业化, 使商品化, 使能营利, 在...发展商业; [经] 使商业化, 使商品化, 在...发展商业 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. exploit for maximal profit, usually by sacrificing quality; v. make commercial
industrialize in'dʌstriəlaɪz POS: vt	vt. 使工业化; vi. 实现工业化 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. organize (the production of something) into an industry; v. develop industry; become industrial
administrate əd'mɪnɪstreɪt POS: vt	vt. 管理, 支配 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v work in an administrative capacity; supervise or be in charge of